Fennel and the Big Teal Lonely

A story about feeling lonely

by KUZU NOHA

Fennel and the Big Teal Lonely

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First edition. Printed by Amazon KDP.

For every little bear
with a big feeling.

Fennel went to the park one day,

ready to swing and slide and play.

But Clover was gone to see her gran.

And everyone else had a friend or a plan.

Ducks played tag. Squirrels shared a ball.

Fennel stood still. He played with no one at all.

A big teal bubble rose up from the ground.

It wrapped him in quiet, without a sound.

Everything sounded far, far away.

He sat on a bench. He had nobody to play.

Mama came over. “Lonely is when

we’d love a friend, and we want one again.”

“First, LOOK around. Who is nearby?

Someone is there, with a kind little eye.”

“Next, say HELLO, with a smile that’s warm.

A hello can melt a lonely storm.”

“Last, INVITE. Ask someone to play.

‘Want to swing with me?’ That’s all you say.”

Fennel looked. A hedgehog, small and shy,

was drawing in the dirt with a stick nearby.

“Hello!” said Fennel. “Want to play?”

“Yes!” said Pip. “I hoped you’d say!”

The teal bubble floated away, soft as a sigh.

Look. Hello. Invite. And a friend is nearby.

Fennel's 3 Friend Steps

1. LOOK

Look around for someone nearby.

2. HELLO

Say hello with a smile.

3. INVITE

Invite someone to play.

Lonely is okay.

A friend is near.

A Note for Grown-Ups

Name the feeling: “You feel lonely.”

Stay close and listen before fixing.

Role-play a hello and an invitation at home.

Arrange short playdates and celebrate every try.

Thank you for reading!

If Fennel helped your little one, a short review on Amazon helps other families find this book.